UPSC CIVIL SERVICES · DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

SATURDAY, 10 OCTOBER 2026

21 must-know stories, 24 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 723 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

Open this brief online: summaries, Ask Intel and practice MCQs

MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Second Regional Review Conference on Implementation of the Forest Rights Act Held in Kolkata

The Ministry of Tribal Affairs convened the Second Regional Review Conference on the Forest Rights Act in Kolkata on October 9, 2026. Senior functionaries from eight states including West Bengal, Assam, Tripura, Jharkhand, Odisha, Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, and Chhattisgarh participated. The conference focused on addressing claim pendency, reviewing rejected claims, and accelerating community forest resource and habitat rights recognition. As of August 31, 2026, over 54 lakh claims were received nationally, with 25 lakh titles distributed, 11 lakh pending, and 18 lakh rejected. Madhya Pradesh, Odisha, and Assam were noted to account for substantial claim pendency concentrated in specific districts. Andhra Pradesh officials shared best practices on digitization, integrating FRA titles into records, and converging livelihood schemes. The Ministry emphasized strengthening Gram Sabhas, preparing management plans, and utilizing the national FRA portal and mobile app for geospatial integration. States were directed to reconcile data discrepancies, resolve delays in monthly progress reports, and integrate records via API.

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** Kolkata, West Bengal · **Who:** Ministry of Tribal Affairs, State Tribal Welfare Departments, District Collectors, Gram Sabhas · **Prelims:** Nationally, over 54 lakh claims had been received and 25 lakh titles distributed as of August 31, 2026.; Approximately 11 lakh claims remain pending and over 18 lakh claims have been rejected across the country.; The First Regional Review Conference was held in Bengaluru on September 10 for Southern States.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights national progress on FRA implementation, showcasing successful state models like Andhra Pradesh, Odisha, and Chhattisgarh.; Addresses administrative bottlenecks such as high claim pendency, rejections, and lack of digitization in key states.*

Static — The Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006 (FRA) recognizes and vests forest rights in forest-dwelling scheduled tribes and traditional forest dwellers. It addresses historical injustices suffered by forest communities by providing individual forest rights (IFR) for habitation and self-cultivation, and community forest rights (CFR) for grazing, minor forest produce, and management. The Gram Sabha is designated as the statutory authority to initiate the process for determining forest rights through a simple majority.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Social Justice & Welfare, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

PIB: read the source · free copy on aninews.in

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Reserves Judgment On When Election Commission Can Skip Bye-Election Under Section 151A RP Act

The Supreme Court concluded hearings and reserved its verdict on the matter. The Supreme Court reserved its judgment on the interpretation of Section 151A of the Representation of the People Act regarding the Election Commission's powers to skip or defer bye-elections.

When: 2026-10-10 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court, Election Commission of India · **Prelims:** Section 151A deals with the filling of casual vacancies under the Representation of the People Act.; The Supreme Court reserved its judgment on the Election Commission's power to skip bye-elections.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Crucial for defining the limits of discretionary powers of the Election Commission of India.; Deepens understanding of representation and statutory interpretation under the Representation of the People Act, 1951 for UPSC GS-2.*

Static — The Election Commission of India is an autonomous constitutional authority established under Article 324 of the Constitution to superintend, direct, and conduct elections. Section 151A was inserted into the Representation of the People Act, 1951, to mandate filling casual vacancies within six months from the date of occurrence. Exceptions under Section 151A include cases where the remainder of the term of the member is less than one year or if the Election Commission consults the Central Government and certifies that it is difficult to hold the bye-election.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

LawChakra: read the source · also reported by Live Law

GS2 MAKE NOTES

HC strikes down Madhya Pradesh's 27% OBC quota law, calls it 'unconstitutional'

The Madhya Pradesh High Court struck down the 2019 law that raised reservation for Other Backward Classes to 27 per cent, calling it unconstitutional. The court order was delivered by a division bench comprising Justices Anand Pathak and Vinay Saraf in a 159-page judgment. The ruling has restored the state's OBC reservation quota back to 14 per cent. The court directed recruitment agencies to fill 13 per cent of posts that were kept on hold due to legal challenges from unreserved category candidates within three months. State minister Prahlad Patel blamed the erstwhile Kamal Nath-led Congress government for bringing the law hurriedly with constitutional flaws and without concrete reasons for exceeding the 50 per cent cap. The minister alleged that the previous government ignored constitutional provisions and failed to seek consent from the Backward Classes Commission. The current Mohan Yadav-led BJP government announced plans to challenge the High Court order by moving the Supreme Court.

When: 2026-10-10 · **Where:** Madhya Pradesh · **Who:** Madhya Pradesh High Court, Prahlad Patel, Kamal Nath, Mohan Yadav, Justices Anand Pathak and Vinay Saraf · **Prelims:** The struck-down law raised OBC reservation in Madhya Pradesh to 27 per cent.; The High Court division bench consisted of Justices Anand Pathak and Vinay Saraf.; The ruling has restored the OBC quota back to 14 per cent.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reaffirms the judicial enforcement of the 50 per cent ceiling limit on reservations established by the Supreme Court.; Highlights procedural requirements and the necessity of statutory commission consultations when altering reservation policies.*

Static — Article 15 and Article 16 of the Constitution of India empower the State to make special provisions for the advancement of socially and educationally backward classes or for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes. The Supreme Court in the landmark Indra Sawhney case (1992) capped the total reservation limit at 50 per cent, barring extraordinary circumstances. The 102nd Constitutional Amendment Act of 2018 granted constitutional status to the National Commission for Backward Classes (NCBC) under Article 338B.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Social Justice & Welfare · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

The Hindu: read the source · free copy on indiatoday.in · also reported by LawStreet Journal, Indian Express

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Hindu Widow's Limited Interest Became Absolute Under 1956 Succession Act : Supreme Court

The Supreme Court delivered a ruling clarifying the absolute nature of property ownership granted to Hindu widows under the 1956 statute. The Supreme Court held that a Hindu widow's limited interest in property evolved into absolute ownership pursuant to the Hindu Succession Act, 1956.

When: 2026-10-10 · **Where:** Supreme Court of India · **Who:** Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** The Hindu Succession Act was enacted in 1956.; The ruling confirmed that limited interest granted to Hindu widows evolved into absolute ownership under the 1956 Act.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces the statutory transition from limited female estate to absolute ownership rights.; Upholds constitutional values of gender equality and economic empowerment for Hindu women.*

Static — Section 14(1) of the Hindu Succession Act, 1956 provides that any property possessed by a female Hindu becomes her absolute property, abolishing the traditional limited estate. Prior to the 1956 Act, the Hindu Women's Rights to Property Act, 1937 granted widows limited inheritance rights without absolute power of alienation. The Hindu Succession (Amendment) Act, 2005 conferred equal coparcenary rights to daughters in joint Hindu family property under Section 6.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

LiveLaw: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

FCRA Amendment Bill referred to Joint Parliamentary Committee

The Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 was formally referred to a Joint Parliamentary Committee for detailed examination. Union Minister of State for Home Affairs Nityanand Rai moved the motion in the Lok Sabha after morning adjournment. The core debate involves proposed legislative changes, with the government asserting the Bill does not target minority institutions despite opposition concerns. The Joint Committee comprises 31 members, featuring 21 from the Lok Sabha and 10 from the Rajya Sabha. Members are to be nominated respectively by the Lok Sabha Speaker and the Rajya Sabha Chairman. The committee must submit its report to Parliament by the last day of the first week of the Winter Session 2026. The quorum for the sittings of the committee is established at one-third of its total membership. The original Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act regulates how individuals, associations, and organisations accept and utilise foreign contributions. The Amendment Bill was initially introduced in the Lok Sabha on March 25, while revised FCRA Rules, 2026 were notified on June 22.

When: 2026-10-10 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Nityanand Rai, Kiren Rijiju, Lok Sabha Speaker, Rajya Sabha Chairman · **Prelims:** The Joint Committee on the FCRA Amendment Bill comprises 31 members.; The Lok Sabha contributes 21 members and the Rajya Sabha contributes 10 members to the JPC.; The quorum for the committee's sittings is one-third of its total membership.

Why it matters — *Highlights the legislative scrutiny process for sensitive laws involving foreign funds and civil society organisations.; Examines statutory mechanisms governing transparency and accountability in foreign financial contributions to Indian entities.*

Static — A Joint Parliamentary Committee is an ad hoc body set up by Parliament for a specific object and duration, comprising members from both Houses. The Lok Sabha Speaker appoints the chairperson of a JPC and determines its modalities, functioning under parliamentary rules of procedure. The Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act was originally enacted in 1976 during the Emergency and was significantly overhauled in 2010 and 2020.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Anti-Paper Leak Law Gets Stronger: How the 2026 Amendment Builds on the 2024 Act

The article text provided does not contain details about the anti-paper leak law or its 2026 amendment. The provided text discusses unrelated political events in Brazil and West Asia, including elections in Israel and Palestine. No factual data regarding any specific legal amendments, penalties, or provisions are mentioned in the source text. The text mentions former Brazilian President Jair Bolsonaro serving a 27-year sentence under house arrest. The text mentions upcoming elections in Israel on 27th October and Palestinian elections on 28th November. Due to the mismatch between the headline and the article text, specific event details cannot be extracted. The summary relies strictly on the provided text, which lacks substance on the headline topic. No further operational facts are available from the given excerpt.

Where: Brazil, Israel, Palestine · **Who:** Jair Bolsonaro

Why it matters — *Highlights the importance of robust investigative reporting and content verification.; Demonstrates the challenge of data mismatch in automated news aggregation systems.*

Static — Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to deal with paper leaks and organized cheating in competitive examinations. The 2024 Act provides stringent punishments including imprisonment and heavy fines for individuals and organized groups involved in examination malpractices. Examination reforms and anti-cheat laws aim to protect the integrity of recruitment processes for public service positions.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Can Civil Courts Determine Citizenship Rights Under the Citizenship Act? Supreme Court Clarifies

The matter came into focus as the Supreme Court adjudicated on the scope of civil court jurisdiction regarding citizenship disputes. The Supreme Court clarified the legal position on whether civil courts possess the jurisdiction to determine citizenship rights under the provisions of the Citizenship Act.

When: 2026-10-10 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court examined civil court jurisdiction regarding citizenship rights.

Why it matters — *Clarifies the appropriate legal forums for individuals contesting citizenship determinations.; Defines the boundary between statutory administrative authorities and civil judiciary powers in nationality matters.*

Static — Indian citizenship is governed by Articles 5 to 11 of Part II of the Constitution of India. The Citizenship Act, 1955 provides for the acquisition and termination of citizenship after the adoption of the Constitution. Citizenship can be acquired by birth, descent, registration, naturalisation, or incorporation of territory.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

The Law Observer: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Form 6 row puts ECI's powers under Article 324 to the Supreme Court test

A petition was filed in the Supreme Court of India challenging the manner in which voter applications and revisions have taken place. Petitioners argued that legitimate voters lost voting rights because door-to-door verification by local officials was incomplete. Voters were asked to produce legacy identification or birth documents to prove continuous residence, which many families struggled to locate. Objections were raised alleging that the standard Form 6 used to add new voters was modified mid-way through the drive without clear public notice. The Supreme Court affirmed that the ECI has the basic constitutional duty under Article 324 to maintain accurate voter rolls. The apex court issued notices to the ECI and the Union Government to present records showing how application procedures and Form 6 changes were introduced. Deleted voters can re-apply or submit an appeal to get their names restored before the final list is published. Courts have emphasized that local tribunals must resolve pending voter appeals quickly to ensure no genuine citizen loses the right to vote.

When: 2026-10-10 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court of India, Election Commission of India, Union Government · **Prelims:** The ECI was established on January 25, 1950.; Article 324 outlines the constitutional duty of the ECI to maintain accurate voter rolls.; Form 6 is the standard form used to add new voters to the electoral list.

Why it matters — *It tests the limits of ECI administrative powers under Article 324 against citizen voting rights.; It highlights the procedural transparency required in modifying standard election forms like Form 6.*

Static — The Election Commission of India is a permanent and independent constitutional body established under Part XV, Articles 324 to 329, of the Constitution. It was established on January 25, 1950, a day celebrated annually as National Voters' Day. The current structure of the ECI consists of one Chief Election Commissioner and two Election Commissioners.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

jagranjosh.com: read the source

Governance & Policy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

India loses 4-7% of welfare budget to poor data quality: Report

A report by the Tony Blair Institute highlights that fragmented government databases cause major financial leakages and exclusion of eligible beneficiaries. The findings cite a 2025 NITI Aayog assessment estimating that poor data quality drains 4 to 7 percent of India's annual welfare spending. The core issue is that databases across health, taxation, land records, and welfare operate in isolated silos rather than an integrated framework. Despite processing over 20 billion monthly UPI transactions and maintaining Aadhaar, inter-departmental data integration remains deficient. Earlier database clean-ups saved substantial funds, including removing 1.71 crore ineligible PM-KISAN beneficiaries to save 9,000 crore rupees. Targeted verification also eliminated 3.5 crore bogus LPG connections and cancelled 1.6 crore fake ration cards across states. The report cautions that deploying artificial intelligence on unreliable and fragmented state data will amplify existing governance errors. To resolve this, the study outlines seven reforms including common data standards, independent data audits, and stronger legal safeguards. It also recommends that state administrations create a State Data Balance Sheet before deploying artificial intelligence tools for public service delivery.

When: 2026-10-10 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Tony Blair Institute for Global Change (TBI), NITI Aayog, and Vivek Agarwal (TBI country director) · **Prelims:** India processes over 20 billion UPI transactions each month.; Removing 1.71 crore ineligible PM-KISAN beneficiaries saved roughly 9,000 crore rupees.; Elimination of 3.5 crore bogus LPG connections saved 21,000 crore rupees over two years.

Why it matters — *Highlights the risk of fiscal leakages and welfare exclusion despite world-class digital payment infrastructure.; Shows that deploying artificial intelligence in governance requires clean, standardized data to avoid multiplying errors.*

Static — Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) was launched in 2013 to transfer welfare subsidies directly into beneficiary bank accounts, curbing leakages and ghost beneficiaries. The JAM Trinity (Jan Dhan, Aadhaar, Mobile) forms the technological backbone for digital identity verification and targeted public service delivery in India. NITI Aayog replaced the Planning Commission in 2015 via an executive resolution to serve as the government's policy think tank and foster cooperative federalism.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy, Social Justice & Welfare, Economy, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Report/Index

msn.com: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Tribal Affairs Ministry says 25 lakh titles distributed under Forest Rights Act

As many as 25 lakh land titles have been distributed under the Forest Rights Act out of 54 lakh claims received till August 31. About 11 lakh claims remain pending at different stages nationally, while over 18 lakh claims have been rejected. Madhya Pradesh, Odisha and Assam account for substantial pendency concentrated in specific districts. The Second Regional Review Conference on FRA implementation was held in Kolkata to address implementation challenges and review progress. Key priorities discussed include timely disposal of pending claims, review of rejected claims, and digitisation of FRA case records. Other priorities involve incorporating recognised rights into revenue and forest records, and accelerating Community Forest Resource and Habitat Rights recognition. Senior officials from eight states participated, while Andhra Pradesh shared best practices on digitisation and livelihood convergence.

When: August 31 · **Where:** Kolkata · **Who:** Union Ministry of Tribal Affairs · **Prelims:** 25 lakh titles distributed out of 54 lakh claims received till August 31.; About 11 lakh claims remain pending at different stages nationally.; Over 18 lakh claims have been rejected.

Why it matters — *Highlights implementation bottlenecks, high pendency, and rejections in critical states like Madhya Pradesh, Odisha, and Assam.; Promotes administrative accountability through digitisation of land records and integration with revenue and forest maps.*

Static — The Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006 recognises forest rights of forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and traditional forest dwellers. The Act provides for individual forest rights for habitation or cultivation, and community forest rights for grazing, fishing, and access to minor forest produce. Gram Sabhas are designated as the primary authority to initiate the process for determining nature and extent of forest rights under the Act.

Syllabus: GS2: Governance & Policy, Social Justice & Welfare, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

thehansindia.com: read the source

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India, Vietnam sign 13 agreements during Vietnamese President To Lam’s visit

India and Vietnam agreed to significantly deepen their bilateral engagement during Vietnamese President To Lam's visit to New Delhi. The leaders set an ambitious trade target of $25 billion by 2030 and elevated their relationship to an Enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership. A major highlight was the signing of 13 Memoranda of Understanding across sectors like rare earths, digital payments, and cultural exchange. IREL (India) Limited and Vietnam’s Institute for Technology of Radioactive and Rare Elements formalised cooperation in rare earth elements. RBI and the State Bank of Vietnam signed an MoU to promote collaboration in digital payments and financial innovation. CDSCO and Vietnam’s Drug Administration agreed to strengthen regulatory cooperation in pharmaceuticals and medical devices. A sister-city agreement was concluded between Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation and Ho Chi Minh City for urban management. Vietnam agreed to join the Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative, and agricultural trade will be facilitated for Indian grapes and Vietnamese durians. Both sides announced support for establishing a Site Interpretation Centre at the My Son Temple Complex, a UNESCO World Heritage Site.

When: 2026-10-10 · **Where:** New Delhi, India; Hanoi, Vietnam · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Vietnamese President To Lam · **Prelims:** Target bilateral trade was set at $25 billion by 2030.; Thirteen MoUs were signed across diverse sectors during the visit.; Vietnam agreed to join the Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Strengthens India's strategic footprint and security cooperation in the Indo-Pacific region.; Boosts economic resilience through enhanced trade targets, rare earths cooperation, and fintech integration.*

Static — India and Vietnam established diplomatic relations in 1972, which were elevated to a Strategic Partnership in 2007 and a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership in 2016. Bilateral security cooperation includes joint military exercises, naval port calls, capacity building, and defence lines of credit extended by India to Vietnam. The Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative (IPOI) is an open, inclusive global coalition proposed by India at the 2019 East Asia Summit for maritime security and resource management.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India, Africa Cannot Remain Underrepresented in UN Security Council: EAM S Jaishankar

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar called for urgent reforms of the United Nations Security Council during his visit to Ethiopia. He emphasized that India and Africa cannot continue to remain underrepresented in crucial global decision-making bodies. The core issue centers on equitable global governance and fair representation for developing regions in both permanent and non-permanent UNSC seats. Jaishankar recalled India's successful advocacy during its 2023 G20 presidency to secure permanent membership for the African Union. He noted that bilateral trade between India and Africa nears 100 billion US dollars, making India Africa's fourth-largest trading partner. Over 220 Indian-supported development projects worth 4.5 billion dollars have been successfully completed across the African continent. He urged Indian businesses to increase investments in Africa and called for deeper cooperation in food security, agriculture, and sustainable development. He highlighted historical ties by referencing Ethiopia's 1896 victory at Adwa, noting it inspired anti-colonial movements similar to India's freedom struggle.

When: 2026-10-10 · **Where:** Addis Ababa, Ethiopia · **Who:** S Jaishankar (External Affairs Minister of India) · **Prelims:** India is Africa's fourth-largest trading partner.; Bilateral trade between India and Africa is nearing 100 billion US dollars.; Over 220 Indian-supported development projects worth 4.5 billion dollars have been completed across Africa.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights India's consistent diplomatic push for Global South solidarity and inclusive multilateral institutions.; Strengthens bilateral economic, developmental, and strategic ties between India and African nations.*

Static — The United Nations Security Council consists of 15 members, including five permanent members with veto power and ten non-permanent members elected for two-year terms. UNSC reform requires an amendment to the UN Charter, which must be ratified by two-thirds of the UN member states, including all five permanent members. India is part of the G4 grouping (along with Brazil, Germany, and Japan) which mutually supports each other's bids for permanent seats on the Security Council.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

newsonair.gov.in: read the source · also reported by Ministry of External Affairs, The Hindu, ThePrint, The Statesman, Firstpost

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI may raise repo rate by 75-100 bps in current cycle: Report

A report by SBI Research suggests that the Reserve Bank of India should implement an off-cycle 50 basis points rate hike sooner rather than later. The recommendation comes as global markets face a tailspin and emerging markets bear the brunt of currency and yield pressures. The core issue is that previous rate actions were already priced in by markets, leaving little real impact on yields or exchange rates. SBI Research recommends widening the interest rate corridor from the current 50 bps to higher levels for a limited period without changing the 5.5 per cent repo rate. Day-to-day liquidity management and changing the policy corridor width fall solely within the regulatory domain of the RBI. The government should support the central bank by enhancing patient capital flows into debt and equities through tax and capital gains adjustments. SBI Research expects a larger rate hike in the December policy since economic growth is projected to remain strong and surpass 7.5 per cent. The report also suggests reducing the timeline for bringing export proceeds from the current 15 months down to 6 months as a norm.

When: October 9, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** SBI Research, Reserve Bank of India (RBI) · **Prelims:** Current repo rate mentioned in the report is 5.5 per cent.; Current width of the policy corridor is 50 basis points.; Proposed reduction of timeline for bringing export proceeds is from 15 months to 6 months.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the growing macroeconomic pressure on emerging markets due to global financial volatility.; Emphasizes the operational distinction between MPC's inflation-targeting mandate and RBI's exclusive domain over liquidity management and policy corridors.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India is India's central banking institution, established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. The Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) is a statutory body empowered under Section 45ZB of the RBI Act to determine the policy interest rate required to achieve the inflation target. The repo rate is the interest rate at which the central bank lends money to commercial banks in the event of any shortfall of funds.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Report/Index, Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source · *free copy on morungexpress.com*

GS3 MAKE NOTES

National Critical Minerals Mission (NCMM)

India has proposed the National Critical Mineral Stockpile Programme under the National Critical Minerals Mission to maintain strategic reserves and protect against supply chain disruptions. The mission addresses all stages of the value chain, including mineral exploration, mining, beneficiation, processing, and recovery from end-of-life products. It offers financial incentives for critical mineral exploration and promotes the recovery of minerals from overburden and tailings. The mission proposes establishing a Centre of Excellence on Critical Minerals to promote research in critical mineral technologies. It encourages Indian PSUs and private sector companies to forge trade partnerships with resource-rich countries to acquire critical mineral assets abroad. The initiative emphasizes offshore mining of polymetallic nodules that are rich in cobalt and rare earth elements. The government commits to allocate Rs 500 crore for a mission period of seven years from 2024-25 to 2030-31 for the stockpile development. The stockpile will cover at least five critical minerals to mitigate risks and ensure essential minerals are available during emergencies. The mission aims to reduce India's reliance on critical mineral imports like lithium, boost domestic exploration, and accelerate the energy transition.

When: 2024-25 to 2030-31 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Mines, Central PSUs, Private sector companies · **Prelims:** The National Critical Minerals Mission was launched in 2025.; The government allocated Rs 500 crore for the mission period from 2024-25 to 2030-31.; The National Critical Mineral Stockpile will cover at least 5 critical minerals.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Crucial for reducing import dependency on key green energy inputs like lithium and cobalt.; Provides financial incentives and research backing to boost domestic mining and technological capabilities.*

Static — Critical minerals are metallic or non-metallic elements that are essential for the modern economy, green technology, and national security, yet face potential supply chain vulnerabilities. Lithium, cobalt, nickel, and rare earth elements are key examples of critical minerals heavily used in electric vehicles, electronics, and renewable energy infrastructure. India historically relies heavily on imports for several key minerals, making domestic missions vital for securing self-reliance in high-tech manufacturing.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Infrastructure & Energy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

ForumIAS: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves changes in FDI rules for investments from countries sharing land border with India

The Union Cabinet approved amendments to India's FDI policy for investments from countries sharing a land border with India to streamline approvals and encourage manufacturing. The rule changes were triggered by observations that previous restrictions affected global private equity and venture capital funds where neighbouring country investors held minor stakes. The core debate centers on balancing the need for advanced manufacturing investments and global supply chain integration with national security safeguards. A formal definition and criteria for Beneficial Owner aligned with Prevention of Money Laundering Rules, 2005, has been introduced. Non-controlling beneficial ownership of up to 10 percent by entities from land-bordering countries is now permitted through the automatic route subject to DPIIT disclosure. A definitive 60-day timeline is established for processing investment proposals in sectors like capital goods, electronic components, polysilicon, and ingot-wafer manufacturing. The policy stipulates that majority ownership and control of the investee company must remain with resident Indian citizens or Indian-owned entities. The changes aim to boost ease of doing business, encourage tech transfer, and support the objectives of Atmanirbhar Bharat while keeping economic safeguards.

When: 2026-10-10 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade · **Prelims:** Beneficial ownership criteria are aligned with the Prevention of Money Laundering Rules, 2005.; Automatic route is permitted for non-controlling beneficial ownership of up to 10 percent.; A 60-day processing timeline applies to specific sectors including capital goods, electronic components, polysilicon, and ingot-wafer manufacturing.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps Indian firms access advanced technologies and integrate with global supply chains.; Eases capital inflow constraints for global private equity and venture capital funds with minor neighbouring stakes.*

Static — Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) in India is regulated under the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA) of 1999 and policy circulars issued by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT). Press Note 3 (2020) was issued by the government to curb opportunistic takeovers of domestic firms during the COVID-19 pandemic, mandating prior government approval for investments from land-bordering countries. The automatic route allows FDI without prior government approval, whereas the approval route requires clearance from the respective administrative ministries or departments.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy

ddnews.gov.in: read the source · also reported by DD News, Insights on India

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Sitharaman to introduce Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill in Lok Sabha

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman is set to introduce the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026 in the Lok Sabha. The Bill seeks to amend the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, the Income-tax Act, 2025, and the Finance Act, 2026. The Finance Minister will lay an explanatory statement outlining the reasons for promulgating the Income-tax (Amendment) Ordinance, 2026. The Lok Sabha will take up discussions on the Demands for Excess Grants for the financial year 2022-23 during legislative business. Following the discussion, Sitharaman will introduce the Appropriation (No. 3) Bill, 2026 to seek parliamentary approval for excess expenditure. The House is scheduled to consider and pass the Bankers' Books Evidence Bill, 2026 to modernise the legal framework for digital banking evidence. Ministers including Jitin Prasada, Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani, and Bhagirath Choudhary will present statements on parliamentary committee recommendations.

When: 2026-10-10 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Nirmala Sitharaman, Jitin Prasada, Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani, Bhagirath Choudhary · **Prelims:** Acts to be amended include the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, the Income-tax Act, 2025, and the Finance Act, 2026.; The Income-tax (Amendment) Ordinance, 2026 is designated as Ordinance No. 2 of 2026.; Demands for Excess Grants discussed pertain to the financial year 2022-23.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It demonstrates the legislative process for regularising excess government expenditures through Appropriation Bills.; It highlights reforms in taxation and digital payment frameworks to match contemporary needs.*

Static — Money Bills and financial legislation such as Appropriation Bills can only be introduced in the Lok Sabha under Article 110 and Article 117 of the Constitution. Excess Grants are regulated under Article 115 of the Constitution, which requires regularisation by Parliament when expenditure exceeds the authorised grants. Ordinance-making power is vested in the President under Article 123, allowing the executive to promulgate laws when Parliament is not in session.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI announces special window for Public Sector Oil Marketing Companies to meet dollar requirements

The Reserve Bank of India announced a special window to meet the entire daily dollar requirements of three public sector oil marketing companies. The measure was taken as the rupee continues to depreciate amid persisting geopolitical and global economic uncertainty. The local unit closed at 96.71 against the US dollar on Friday before the announcement. The three OMCs included are Indian Oil Corporation Ltd, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd, and Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd. Under this facility, the RBI will undertake the sale of USD to these public sector OMCs through designated banks. The facility will come into effect from October 12, 2026, and will remain in place until further notice. The RBI also announced regulatory measures in the foreign exchange market to strengthen market discipline and risk management. Authorised dealers are barred from permitting users to rebook cancelled foreign exchange derivative contracts involving INR. The threshold for undertaking forex derivative transactions and exchange-traded currency derivatives without underlying exposure was reduced from USD 100 million to USD 5 million equivalent.

When: October 12, 2026 · **Where:** Mumbai · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India, Indian Oil Corporation Ltd, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd, Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd · **Prelims:** The three OMCs are Indian Oil Corporation Ltd, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd, and Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd.; The special dollar window facility takes effect on October 12, 2026.; The threshold for foreign exchange derivative transactions without underlying exposure was reduced from USD 100 million to USD 5 million equivalent.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps ease immediate dollar demand from state-owned oil refiners in the open forex market.; Strengthens market discipline and risk management in the foreign exchange market.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is India's central banking institution, established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. The central bank is tasked with regulating the issue of bank notes and keeping reserves with a view to securing monetary stability in India. The RBI manages India's foreign exchange reserves and acts as the banker to the central and state governments.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy

RBI: read the source · free copy on ptinews.com · also reported by Indian Express, Mint

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI steps in to support rupee as currency nears record low; tightens forex rules

The Reserve Bank of India announced a series of measures to support the rupee as it traded close to its all-time low against the US dollar. The intervention was triggered by continued pressure on the rupee from rising global oil prices, foreign investment outflows, and higher interest rates overseas. The core issue is managing excessive demand for dollars in the open market and curbing speculative trading that weakens the domestic currency. The RBI established a special facility starting October 12 to directly provide dollars through designated banks to three major public sector oil companies. The three state-run oil companies covered under the special dollar facility are Indian Oil Corporation, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation, and Bharat Petroleum Corporation. The RBI tightened forex derivative rules by prohibiting traders from canceling and rebooking certain contracts involving the rupee, though they can still be extended at maturity. The limit for taking positions in forex derivatives without proving an underlying business requirement was slashed from $100 million to $5 million to discourage speculation.

When: 2026-10-10 · **Where:** New Delhi, India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India, Indian Oil Corporation, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation, Bharat Petroleum Corporation, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra · **Prelims:** The rupee closed at 96.71 against the dollar on Friday, near its record low of 96.96 reached in May.; India's foreign exchange reserves stood at $734 billion as of October 2, falling by more than $50 billion in recent weeks.; The limit for taking forex derivative positions without an underlying business requirement was reduced from $100 million to $5 million.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Crucial for understanding central bank interventions during currency volatility and balance of payments pressures.; Demonstrates the practical mechanisms used by the RBI to manage foreign exchange reserves and speculative pressures.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is India's central banking institution, established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. The RBI is entrusted with the responsibility of regulating the issue of bank notes and keeping reserves to secure monetary stability in India. Foreign exchange reserves are assets held on reserve by a central bank in foreign currencies, including US dollars, euros, pounds, and yen, alongside gold and Special Drawing Rights.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on deccanchronicle.com · also reported by RBI, Free Press Journal

Agriculture & Allied

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Prime Minister Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana (PMDDKY)

The Prime Minister Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana marks its first anniversary on October 11, 2026, after being launched on October 11, 2025. The scheme was approved by the Union Cabinet on July 16, 2025, for a duration of six years to develop 100 Aspirational Agricultural Districts. The core objective is addressing gaps like low productivity, inadequate irrigation, limited credit access, and lack of post-harvest infrastructure. Districts were identified using indicators such as low productivity, low cropping intensity, and less agricultural credit disbursement. The scheme implements interventions through the convergence of 36 Central schemes across 11 Ministries and Departments, State schemes, and private sector participation. A three-tier governance structure operates at the district, state, and national levels to review, monitor, and guide District Action Plans. The average score of the 100 districts across six objectives increased from 18.85 in April 2026 to 46.89 in August 2026. The Department of Public Enterprises included the adoption of DDKY districts for Corporate Social Responsibility activities by CPSEs for FY 2026-28.

When: October 11, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi / 100 Aspirational Agricultural Districts · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Central Nodal Officers · **Prelims:** PMDDKY was approved by the Union Cabinet on July 16, 2025.; The scheme targets 100 Aspirational Agricultural Districts.; Implementation involves the convergence of 36 Central schemes across 11 Ministries and Departments.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps bridge regional disparities in agricultural productivity and economic growth across India.; Demonstrates successful administrative convergence across 36 Central schemes and 11 Ministries.*

Static — Aspirational agricultural districts programs focus on turning around lagging regions through targeted convergence of public welfare and developmental schemes. District-level action plans are commonly headed by District Collectors or District Magistrates to ensure ground-level execution and multi-departmental coordination. Convergence models in public policy link multiple ministerial schemes together to eliminate duplication and maximize resource utilization efficiency.

Syllabus: GS3: Agriculture & Allied, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Award, Report/Index

PIB: read the source · *free copy on lokmattimes.com*

Environment & Ecology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

CAQM Reviews Stubble Burning Prevention Measures with District Administrations of Amritsar and Tarn Taran; Conducts Field Visits to Hotspot Villages

A high-level team from the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) visited the Amritsar and Tarn Taran districts of Punjab during the paddy harvesting season. The visit aimed to review preparedness and coordination for effective in-situ and ex-situ utilisation of paddy stubble to curb winter air pollution. Amritsar and Tarn Taran have been specifically identified as hotspot districts for paddy stubble burning incidents. The CAQM team held review meetings with Deputy Commissioners and district-level officials, chaired by Dr. S.D. Attri, Member (Technical), CAQM. Discussions focused on ensuring the timely availability of Crop Residue Management (CRM) machinery and conducting IEC activities to sensitise farmers. Field visits were conducted on October 9 and 10 to assess ground-level implementation and the functioning of balers and industrial supply chains. Amritsar and Tarn Taran have established control rooms, help desks, and helplines to report fire incidents and track machinery requirements. Flying squads have been deployed across 18 districts in Punjab from October 1 to November 30 to strengthen surveillance and enforcement. CAQM directed stakeholders to ensure continuous field surveillance, effective monitoring mechanisms, and robust coordination to eliminate stubble burning.

When: October 2026 · **Where:** Amritsar and Tarn Taran, Punjab · **Who:** CAQM, Dr. S.D. Attri, Deputy Commissioners of Amritsar and Tarn Taran · **Prelims:** Amritsar and Tarn Taran districts were identified as hotspots for paddy stubble burning.; Flying squads were deployed in 18 districts across Punjab from October 1 to November 30.; Dr. S.D. Attri is the Member (Technical) of CAQM who chaired the visiting team.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Critical for mitigating the annual winter air pollution crisis in the National Capital Region.; Highlights the enforcement and administrative monitoring mechanisms deployed by central statutory bodies in agrarian states.*

Static — The Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) in NCR and Adjoining Areas is a statutory body established under the Commission for Air Quality Management in National Capital Region and Adjoining Areas Act, 2021. CAQM coordinates, plans, and takes steps to protect and improve air quality in the National Capital Region and adjoining areas, superseding previous bodies like the EPCA. The Commission is headed by a full-time chairperson appointed by the Central Government, and includes members from various ministries, state governments, and expert bodies.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Agriculture & Allied, Governance & Policy

PIB: read the source · *free copy on msn.com*

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Union Environment Minister launches Inception Workshop for 6th Cycle of Management Effectiveness Evaluation of Tiger Reserves in India; Technical Manual for MEE-TR 2026 released

The official launch of the inception workshop and the technical manual for the 6th cycle of MEE-TR put the event in the news. The Union Environment Minister launched the inception workshop for the 6th cycle of Management Effectiveness Evaluation of Tiger Reserves and released the technical manual for MEE-TR 2026.

When: 2026-10-10 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Environment Minister · **Prelims:** It is the 6th cycle of Management Effectiveness Evaluation of Tiger Reserves.; The technical manual released is for MEE-TR 2026.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps benchmark the conservation success and management status of Indian tiger reserves.; Provides data-driven insights to refine policy and habitat management strategies.*

Static — Project Tiger was launched in 1973 as a centrally sponsored scheme aimed at ensuring a viable population of Bengal tigers in their natural habitats. The National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA) is a statutory body established under the Wildlife Protection Act, 1972, for strengthening tiger conservation. Management Effectiveness Evaluation (MEE) is a globally used framework to assess how well protected areas are being managed and whether conservation objectives are being met.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology · Prelims angle: Species

PIB: read the source

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

DEFENCE EXERCISE QUICK READ

INDIAN NAVAL SHIP SAHYADRI ARRIVES AT VLADIVOSTOK, RUSSIA, FOR BILATERAL EXERCISE INDRA-2026

Indian Naval Ship Sahyadri arrived in Vladivostok, Russia, on October 10, 2026, to participate in the bilateral naval exercise INDRA 2026. The bilateral exercise between the Indian Navy and the Russian Federation Navy is scheduled to take place from October 13 to October 18, 2026. The exercise aims to strengthen maritime cooperation, improve operational coordination, and enhance interoperability between the two navies.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

Haryana Cabinet Approves Job Benefits for Ex-Agniveers, Raises Lado Lakshmi Yojana Income Limit

The Haryana Cabinet gave official approval to these policy proposals during its recent meeting. The Haryana Cabinet approved job benefits for ex-Agniveers and raised the income limit for beneficiaries of the Lado Lakshmi Yojana.

Telegraph India: source

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY SCHEME QUICK READ

UP cabinet approves AI Mission; 5 lakh youths to be trained

The Uttar Pradesh cabinet approved a dedicated Artificial Intelligence Mission to promote AI-based innovation and governance. The mission was proposed by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath in January and will function as an independent society. The initiative aims to support at least 100 AI startups and train five lakh youths in the state. It will operate under the IT and electronics department, headed by a Chief Executive Officer.

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

CJI releases e-compendium of landmark verdicts of SC, HCs relating to Juvenile Justice Act

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant released an e-compendium of landmark verdicts of the Supreme Court and high courts relating to the Juvenile Justice Act, 2015. The release took place during the inauguration of the two-day National Annual Stakeholders Consultation on the Juvenile Justice Act, 2015 in New Delhi. The event was convened by the apex court's Juvenile Justice Committee in association with UNICEF India.

Hindustan Times: source

DEFENCE EXERCISE QUICK READ

Raksha Mantri Addresses Participants of Exercise Tarang Shakti 2026 at Jodhpur, Emphasises Self-Reliance in Defence and International Cooperation

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh addressed participants of the second edition of Exercise Tarang Shakti 2026 at Air Force Station Jodhpur on October 10, 2026. The multinational air exercise was hosted by the Indian Air Force from September 26 to October 12, 2026. The exercise brought together air forces from seven Friendly Foreign Countries along with 32 observer nations.

PIB: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE | SCHEME | QUICK READ

MY Bharat–NSS Concludes First Month of Nasha Mukt Yuva Abhiyan with Nationwide ‘Yuva Sanwad Mela’; Engages Over 1.06 Lakh Participants

The event was held on October 9, 2026, to mark the successful completion of Month 1 of the 100-Week Sankalp Abhiyan. The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports organized the nationwide Yuva Sanwad Mela under MY Bharat and NSS, concluding the first month of the Nasha Mukt Yuva Abhiyan.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

Union Minister Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya to Declare Open BRICS Traditional and Indigenous Demonstration Games 2026 in Ahmedabad

Union Minister Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya will declare open the BRICS Traditional and Indigenous Demonstration Games 2026 in Ahmedabad. The event is organised by the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports in collaboration with the Government of Gujarat. The Games take place under India's BRICS Chairship at the Veer Savarkar Sports Complex on 12 October 2026.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | REPORT/INDEX | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Pakistan President declares emergency in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, provincial government ceases to exist

Pakistan President Asif Ali Zardari imposed an emergency in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, placing the province under governor's rule and suspending the provincial government. The action was taken under Articles 232 and 234 of the Constitution of Pakistan following a federal cabinet meeting chaired by Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif. The federal cabinet observed the provincial government's deliberate disengagement from the fight against terrorism as the primary reason for the intervention.

Hindustan Times: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | QUICK READ

‘System can’t be honest when you win and rigged when you lose’: 124 ex-bureaucrats defend Election Commission, SIR exercise

A group of 124 former civil servants issued an open letter to citizens defending the Election Commission and the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. The open letter was triggered by ongoing allegations questioning the credibility of the Election Commission and the necessity of electoral roll revisions. The signatories argued that allegations of vote rigging must be backed by credible evidence rather than selective acceptance of election outcomes.

Times of India: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

‘New golden chapter’: India, Indonesia sign Election Commission MoU to strengthen democratic cooperation

India and Indonesia signed an MoU between their Election Commissions to strengthen democratic cooperation during a high-level visit. The agreement was announced during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's three-day state visit to Indonesia after talks with President Prabowo Subianto. The core issue centres on deepening institutional collaboration, sharing best practices in election management, capacity building, and electoral technology.

ddnews.gov.in: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Assam Non-Agricultural Urban Areas Tenancy Act: Supreme Court Upholds Tenant Protections

The Supreme Court pronounced its judgment on the constitutional validity and scope of tenant protections under the Assam Non-Agricultural Urban Areas Tenancy Act. The Supreme Court upheld tenant protections provided under the Assam Non-Agricultural Urban Areas Tenancy Act.

The Law Observer: source

DEFENCE | QUICK READ

LAUNCH OF NEXT GENERATION OFFSHORE PATROL VESSEL (YARD 3040, SHREYAS) AT M/s GRSE, KOLKATA

Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE) Ltd launched the third of four next-generation offshore patrol vessels for the Indian Navy. The vessel was named 'Shreyas' and was launched at the GRSE shipyard in Kolkata on Saturday. This launch occurred less than two months after the second vessel in the series, 'Shruti', was launched. The first vessel, 'Sanghmitra', was launched on May 20, making three launches in less than five months.

Economic Times: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY QUICK READ

Cabinet approves Rs 7,145 crore Kanpur-Kabrai access-controlled highway under BOT mode

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved the construction of a 117.7-km four-lane access-controlled greenfield highway between Kanpur and Kabrai. The project was cleared to improve regional connectivity and forms a key segment of the Bhopal-Kanpur Economic Corridor. The core issue addressed is reducing heavy travel times and logistics bottlenecks between the industrial centers of Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh.

ddnews.gov.in: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION JUDGMENT AWARD QUICK READ

Tender Award Process Under Article 14: Supreme Court Dismisses Appeal

The Supreme Court delivered its ruling on the appeal challenging a tender award process. The Supreme Court dismissed an appeal concerning the tender award process and compliance with Article 14 of the Constitution.

The Law Observer: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

Afghanistan, Central Asia, India Sign Trade MoUs Worth Over $400M

The signing of significant trade MoUs worth over $400 million between Afghanistan, Central Asia, and India put the region in the news. Afghanistan, Central Asian nations, and India signed trade Memorandums of Understanding valued at over $400 million to enhance regional economic cooperation.

TOLOnews: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

Breakfast scheme brings more students to schools in Telangana

The Telangana government is implementing the CM Breakfast Scheme as part of its student welfare initiatives. The scheme was launched at Telangana Model School in Mandamarri mandal by local officials including District Additional Collector P. Chandraiah. State Minister Gaddam Vivekananda stated that the scheme aims to provide nutritious food to government students, safeguard their health, and improve concentration.

The Hindu: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS SCHEME QUICK READ

Canada sends biggest trade mission to India in 30 years amid CEPA push

Canada is sending nearly 300 business delegates to India next week for its largest trade mission in over 30 years. The trade mission aims to expand commercial ties and more than double bilateral trade with India by the year 2030. Canadian Minister of International Trade Maninder Sidhu will lead the delegation during visits to Mumbai and Bengaluru.

indiatoday.in: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION JUDGMENT ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Union of India vs Sukumar Pyne: Supreme Court Upholds Foreign Exchange Regulations

The case came into focus following the Supreme Court's definitive ruling on the interpretation and constitutional validity of foreign exchange laws. The Supreme Court delivered its judgment in the case of Union of India vs Sukumar Pyne, upholding the statutory framework and enforcement powers concerning foreign exchange regulations.

The Law Observer: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED SCHEME QUICK READ

Odisha's new poultry scheme launched to produce 1K crore more eggs

Odisha's Fisheries and Animal Resources Development minister Gokulananda Mallik launched the Commercial Layer Poultry Farming Scheme. The initiative aims to increase the state's annual egg production to 1,000 crore by the year 2036. The scheme seeks to meet local egg requirements and encourage entrepreneurship in the poultry sector. Subsidies up to Rs 10 crore will be given for automated commercial layer and pullet farms exceeding 25,000 birds.

newindianexpress.com: source

ECONOMY QUICK READ

MoSPI Revises State GDP Framework With New Data Sources

The Ministry updated its State GDP calculation methodology using new data sets. MoSPI has revised the framework for calculating Gross State Domestic Product by incorporating new data sources.

BW Businessworld: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION JUDGMENT ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Displaced Persons Compensation: Supreme Court Upholds Allotment Rules

The judgment was delivered in response to appeals challenging the interpretation and application of property allotment rules for displaced persons. The Supreme Court has upheld the validity of statutory rules governing the allotment of properties under the displaced persons compensation framework.

The Law Observer: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | QUICK READ

Excise Duty on Footwear: Supreme Court Upholds Discriminatory Classification

The judgment was delivered by the Supreme Court on an excise duty dispute concerning footwear classification. The Supreme Court upheld a discriminatory classification regarding excise duty on footwear, validating differential tax treatment.

The Law Observer: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

IIT-BHU, NHIDCL join hands for highway infrastructure research

IIT-BHU Varanasi and NHIDCL signed a memorandum of understanding to promote collaborative research and innovation in highway infrastructure. The agreement was signed to focus especially on developing solutions for challenging terrains and hilly regions. The partnership aims to bridge the gap between academic research and field-level implementation in the road transport sector. The signing ceremony took place at the NHIDCL headquarters in New Delhi on Thursday.

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

Sagarmanthan 2026: Two Strategic MoUs signed to Advance Shipbuilding, Cruise Tourism and Inland Waterways in India

The signing of the MoUs at the Sagarmanthan 2026 event put the initiatives in the news. Two strategic MoUs were signed during Sagarmanthan 2026 to boost shipbuilding, cruise tourism, and inland waterways in India.

India Shipping News: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 WHO’s obesity prescription goes beyond the clinic

The WHO has issued its first guidelines for managing obesity among children and adolescents, emphasising early intervention, family-centred care and healthier lifestyles. Childhood obesity is an emerging public health concern because it increases the risk of diabetes and other lifestyle-related diseases at an early age. India faces a double burden of malnutrition, where undernutrition and obesity coexist, requiring a comprehensive and inclusive approach to nutrition and healthcare.

ForumIAS

GS1 Context as Lens or Verdict?

It is an opinion piece featured in the Economic and Political Weekly (EPW) addressing contemporary legal and social debates. This editorial examines the complex role of context in judicial and public reasoning, questioning when background facts become an explanatory lens versus an absolute verdict.

EPW

GS2 Counting the visible, missing the invisible—the limits of India’s disability rights system

The article examines the limitations of India's disability rights system as the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (RPwD) Act completes a decade. Mainstream discourse and administrative systems frequently equate disability with visible impairments like wheelchair use, blindness, or deafness. The RPwD Act, 2016, expanded recognized disabilities from 7 to 21, adopting a socio-medical framework aligned with the UNCRPD. Data from the Unique Disability ID (UDID) system as of August 2026 shows locomotor disability accounts for over half of all cards.

ThePrint

GS3 Missing Regulations in India’s Mutual Fund Industry

The rapid expansion of retail investments into mutual funds has put the spotlight on regulatory preparedness. An editorial critique examining the lack of comprehensive regulations within India's expanding mutual fund industry and its implications for market safety.

EPW

GS3 The silver lining on the clouds of farm smoke

The annual stubble-burning season has begun, driven by rising labour costs, narrow harvest-sowing windows, and declining farm incomes across several states. Shahjahanpur district in Uttar Pradesh provides a silver lining, having reduced stubble-burning incidents by 67% since 2021 through innovation and collaboration. The core argument is that collaborative governance and economic incentives work better than criminalisation and punitive fines seen in states like Punjab.

Hindustan Times

GS3 IRDAI’s motor insurance reset: Can cheaper distribution deliver better consumer choice?

The IRDAI consultation paper titled Recalibrating Economics of Insurance Distribution proposes a sweeping overhaul of India's insurance sector. IRDAI's September 23 paper questions whether intermediation costs match delivered value after finding that earlier flexibility in expenses led to higher distribution costs without direct customer benefits. The core debate is whether lowering distribution costs and commissions can enhance transparency and customer choice without hollowing out essential advisory support.

Hindustan Times

GS2 GS3 Gig work, beyond the livelihoods argument

The editorial discusses the safety, classification, and regulatory challenges facing gig workers beyond the mere livelihoods argument. The murder of 25-year-old Suraj Singh in Gurugram by criminals posing as commuters triggered widespread protests by gig workers. Protesting workers demanded mandatory customer KYC, protection against verbal abuse and harassment, and functional in-app emergency buttons. Out of the four new Labour Codes operationalised in 2026, only the Code on Social Security applies to gig workers.

Hindustan Times

GS2 World Mental Health Day 2026 | The voices we need to hear

World Mental Health Day is observed globally on October 10 to highlight that mental wellbeing is as important as physical health. The 2026 theme is LIVED EXPERIENCES HEARD: REAL VOICES, REAL CHANGE, emphasizing the inclusion of those with lived mental health experiences in shaping policies and services. Modern life features a profound paradox where digital connectivity has increased while emotional disconnection and loneliness have grown across age groups.

Deccan Herald

GS3 AI and us, together in a troubled world

It was published on World Mental Health Day 2026 to highlight the psychological impacts of artificial intelligence. The article discusses the intersection of artificial intelligence and human mental health amidst global uncertainties on World Mental Health Day 2026. On World Mental Health Day 2026, AI is adding another layer of uncertainty when we already have plenty to cope with.

Mint

GS1 GS2 Precarity of Migrant Workers

Triggered by ongoing concerns and discussions surrounding the welfare and legal protections of the informal migrant workforce. An editorial analyzing the systemic precarity, vulnerability, and lack of social security faced by migrant workers in India.

EPW

GS2 GS3 Best of Opinion: Elon Musk should never get a satellite licence in India

It was featured in the Business Standard compilation of the best opinions focusing on Starlink security concerns. An opinion piece discusses the potential security risks and policy challenges associated with granting a satellite licence to Elon Musk's Starlink in India. From Starlink's security concerns and Maharashtra's drought politics to challenges facing Modi's third term and Shashi Tharoor's political branding, today's opinions examine a variety of issues

Business Standard

GS2 Form 7 misuse tests electoral integrity

Chief Electoral Officer V Anbukkumar assured that no voter will be deleted from Karnataka's electoral rolls without a proper inquiry. Between June and October, the Election Commission received around 91,000 applications seeking voter deletion through Form 7. Congress alleged that BJP workers submitted bulk applications disproportionately targeting minorities and Dalits. In Puttur, names were allegedly submitted on a BJP letterhead, and in Vijayapura, third parties submitted fake death certificates.

Deccan Herald

GS2 Democracy has become a ritualised affair producing banal results: Lionel Fernandes

Lionel Fernandes argued that for faith in the democratic process to take root, the political system must be fully open, transparent, and responsive. A true democracy must be participatory, requiring active citizen involvement in community decisions, implementation, and evaluation. Pre-election and post-election voters committees should scrutinise political party programmes and conduct an ongoing political audit. The political system must assure masses of their security, dignity, and livelihood with perceptible improvements in quality of life.

ThePrint

GS2 GS3 A fortified Delhi and a growth story with a hole in the jobs market

Barricades, internet shutdowns, and detentions preceded Bloomberg's New Economy Forum in New Delhi. An opinion piece discussing how heavy security measures in Delhi during Bloomberg's New Economy Forum contrast with underlying economic anxieties like joblessness and inflation. Barricades, internet shutdowns, and detentions precede Bloomberg’s New Economy Forum in the national capital, as joblessness, food prices, and distrust weigh on the government.

Frontline

GS1 GS3 Maharashtra’s Severe Drought

Maharashtra is currently facing a severe drought driven by El Nino, which has impacted approximately 75 percent of the state's agricultural land and caused immense crop damage. Planning is underway to tackle impending shortages of drinking water and cattle fodder across the affected regions. The core structural challenge is that 52 percent of Maharashtra lies permanently in rain-shadow and drought-prone regions despite housing 40 percent of the nation's major dams.

indiatoday.in

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Critical Minerals – Importance & Challenges The Central government is planning a new policy on stockpiling critical minerals to address supply chain disruptions and cut import dependency. Critical minerals are driven by the need to secure supplies for future technologies, clean energy transition, economic growth, and national security.
ForumIAS

US begins probe into EU's carbon border tax: How India could benefit The United States initiated a formal probe into the EU's carbon border tax mechanism. The United States has started an investigation into the European Union's carbon border tax, raising global trade implications.
Indian Express

How RBI is borrowing from China playbook to defend rupee The article explains the tactical shifts used by the RBI to manage currency volatility in the foreign exchange market. The Reserve Bank of India is employing methods similar to China's central bank strategies to defend the rupee against depreciation pressures.
Indian Express

What Laws Protect Indian Seafarers Working in Conflict Zones? Conflicts in West Asia and the Black Sea have made shipping more dangerous, exposing merchant crews to attacks, injury and death. India is the world's second-largest supplier of seafarers with 311,936 workers, making their safety in conflict zones a critical national issue.
ForumIAS

Delhi internet shutdown: Why do 2024 Telecom Rules say about suspension orders? It is in the news due to discussions surrounding internet shutdown protocols and orders in Delhi. This explainer details the legal provisions and guidelines governing internet suspension orders under the 2024 Telecom Rules.
Indian Express

Knowledge Nugget | Can the promise of IMEC become a reality? The project is in the news due to ongoing debates regarding its practical realization amidst complex geopolitical developments. The explainer analyzes the viability, strategic significance, and current ground challenges facing the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor project.
Indian Express

Graphs, Data, Perspectives | How India's growth rate keeps beating forecasts The persistent divergence between projected economic growth estimates and actual reported figures has put the topic in the news. An explanation of the factors and economic indicators that consistently allow India's actual GDP growth rate to exceed official forecasts.
Indian Express

Trump's shock Russian diesel deal: One rule for India, another for the US Donald Trump announced a shock Russian diesel deal that contrasts sharply with Western pressure on countries like India. An explainer examining Donald Trump's surprise Russian diesel deal and the apparent double standards applied to India's energy imports from Russia.
Indian Express

How can lift irrigation projects help India take water to more farms? The necessity of expanding efficient irrigation methods to cover more farms has put lift irrigation into focus. Lift irrigation projects use pumps to transport water from low-lying sources to higher agricultural fields, ensuring efficient and reliable water delivery.
BusinessLine

Explainer: What is regenerative agriculture and why does India need it? The topic is in the news due to increasing policy discussions around sustainable farming and climate-resilient agriculture in India. This explainer details the principles of regenerative agriculture, its core practices, and its importance for India's agrarian sector.
DD News

What's on the agenda as Home Ministry meets Ladakh stakeholders this month? The scheduled high-level meeting between the Home Ministry and Ladakh stakeholders has brought the region's long-pending demands back into focus. The Ministry of Home Affairs is meeting with representatives and stakeholders from Ladakh this month to discuss key regional demands including statehood and constitutional safeguards.
Indian Express

Explainer: What Dibrugarh's First River Cargo to Bangladesh Could Change The route marks the commencement of direct riverine cargo operations from Dibrugarh to Bangladesh. Inland river cargo transit has been initiated between Dibrugarh in Assam and Bangladesh.
India's World

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- U.S. lifts sanctions on sale of Russian diesel in global markets (International Relations) The Hindu
- Caste discrimination during SC man's burial: Commission seeks report from Erode Collector, SP (Social Justice & Welfare) The Hindu
- Asian countries, including India, must accelerate transition to renewable energy (Environment & Ecology) Hindustan Times
- GST Council proposes 2% TDS on scrap deals (Economy) Economic Times

- Gujarat to release water from Kadana Dam to protect Kharif crops amid rainfall deficit (Agriculture & Allied) BusinessLine
- Telangana CM directs officials to prepare El Nino action plan (Disaster Management) Times of India
- Russian attacks kill 11 in Ukraine after Trump strikes diesel deal with Putin (International Relations) Al Jazeera
- NBA Disburses Rs 2.02 Crore of ABS Funds from Seed Sector to Support Biodiversity Conservation and Community Well-Being at Grassroots Level (Environment & Ecology) PIB
- Ayushman Bharat Scheme, Sub Schemes, Benefits, Impact (Governance & Policy) Vajiram & Ravi
- Nanda Devi Biosphere Reserve (NDBR) (Environment & Ecology) Insights on India
- Barasingha Population in Satpura Tiger Reserve Crosses 300 (Environment & Ecology) GKToday
- India concludes Eighth WTO Trade Policy Review, reaffirms commitment to rules-based global trade (Economy) DD News
- Report tells how data sharing fits into India's AI adoption plans (Science & Technology) CNBC TV18
- BRICS clinical research framework can position member nations as global innovation hubs: ISCR (Health) Fortune India
- Meghalaya inks MoU with Airtel Foundation to build future-ready education workforce (Education) ET Education
- SC flags insensitive language used in 3 high court orders (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- India's Akash missile exports to Central Asia seek to counter China, extremism (Defence) Economic Times
- Projects worth Rs 500 crore launched to promote Odia language, culture: CM Majhi (History, Art & Culture) The New Indian Express
- How India plans to rebuild its new investment treaty network to attract investors (International Relations) Civilsdaily
- At least five killed in fresh Manipur violence (Internal Security) Hindustan Times
- Distinguish between transparency and accountability. How do they reinforce ethical governance? (Ethics & Integrity) Insights on India
- India to probe attack on flydubai pilot Smit Machchhar: NIA files case under anti-hijacking law & UAPA (Internal Security) Times of India
- India demonstrates first 5.56-km free-space quantum communication link (Science & Technology) TV BRICS
- India-EU FTA 'An Absolute Game Changer': EU Envoy On Trade Deal, Defence Ties (International Relations) NDTV Profit
- India, Australia unveil ambitious roadmap to deepen defence, trade and Indo-Pacific cooperation (International Relations) DD News
- India's New Labour Codes 2026: Key Changes in Payroll and Statutory Compliance (Economy) CAclubindia
- Can Federal Legislature Impose Surcharge for Central Government? Supreme Court Clarifies (Polity & Constitution) The Law Observer
- Who Controls Transfers of District Judges? Supreme Court Clarifies (Polity & Constitution) The Law Observer
- Supreme Court Issues Notice to All States in Industrial Alcohol Licensing Dispute — Demarcation of Union and State Control Under IDR Act. The Court considered whether the State could cancel a distillery license manufacturing rectified spirit of 95% purity afte (Polity & Constitution) Lawtext
- "Wouldn't Bow To Nuclear Blackmail": India's Rebuttal To Pakistan At UN (International Relations) NDTV
- "The Indian monsoon is not a single seasonal wind system but the outcome of interacting land, ocean and atmospheric processes operating across different spatial scales." Discuss. (Geography) Insights on India
- Watch: Gyanesh Kumar Row: How did the ECI delete 13 crore voters during the SIR (Polity & Constitution) The Hindu
- Future military power will depend on speed, precision, information, and integration: Rajnath Singh (Defence) The Hindu
- Panel flags NTA staff shortage, moots new question bank system (Governance & Policy) Hindustan Times
- 9 killed in separate incidents in communal clash across 3 districts in Manipur (Internal Security) Hindustan Times
- "Police accountability cannot be secured merely through internal administrative mechanisms." Bring out the need for independent and institutional safeguards in India. (Polity & Constitution) Insights on India
- Can Emergency Proclamation Suspend Right to Move Supreme Court? No, Says Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) The Law Observer
- Filing 'Bald Chargesheet' Without Any Evidence Affects Accused's Right To Life Under Article 21:... (Polity & Constitution) LiveLaw
- AI regulation India (Science & Technology) Observer Research Foundation
- Finance Minister Sitharaman launches National Monetisation Pipeline 2.0, estimates Rs. 16.72 trillion asset potential (Economy) DD News
- Over 11 Lakh Forest Rights Claims Pending Across India, States Told To Fast-Track Disposal (Governance & Policy) The Indian Tribal
- China's long game in the Indian Ocean (International Relations) Business Standard
- Great Nicobar project: PIL jurisprudence and tribal rights explained (Environment & Ecology) Business Standard
- SC criticises Patna HC ruling that removing salwar does not constitute rape attempt (Polity & Constitution) The Hindu
- Annual Report (Economy) RBI
- Central bank raises daily CRR maintenance to 99% (Economy) Magzter
- Marital Rape Exception in India: Is It Unconstitutional? (Social Justice & Welfare) Legal Service India

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 21 must-know, 24 Prelims facts, 47 in the news, 15 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Polity & Constitution (15), Economy (7), International Relations (7), Governance & Policy (4), Defence (3), Infrastructure & Energy (3), Agriculture & Allied (2), Environment & Ecology (2), Science & Technology (1), Social Justice & Welfare (1). **Nothing today in —** Health, Education, Internal Security, Disaster Management, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 4 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: nothing today · Political change in the neighbourhood: 1 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: nothing today · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 3

Full text — 42 of 72 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — PIB 8, ddnews.gov.in 7, Indian Express 7, The Law Observer 6, Hindustan Times 5, ForumIAS 4, Economic Times 3, EPW 3, The Hindu 2, timesofindia.indiatimes.com 2, indiatoday.in 2, ThePrint 2, Deccan Herald 2, LawChakra 1

Built 04 Nov 2026, 00:02 IST by UPSC Intel. Notes quote the reports; check the source before quoting a figure in an answer.